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FUNDRAISING

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Pre-seed vs seed: what investors expect at each

What to prove at each stage before you raise



01

Pre-seed is often about the problem

At pre-seed, many investors ask whether you understand the problem well enough to be right about it. Show what customers have taught you so far.

02

Seed often asks for repeatable proof

By seed, many investors want to see that a process brings in customers and that you can explain why. Show the numbers you track, even if they are small.

03

Traction means different things

Early traction can be letters of intent, paid pilots, or customers who come back. Count the things that involve real commitment.

04

At pre-seed, the team often is the pitch

Show what you have already built and why you are the right person to solve this.

05

Seed usually needs a clear money story

Link spend to customers to revenue on one page. Know your unit economics even if the numbers are early and rough.

06

Match the round to the milestone

Raise too early and you give away equity with little to show. Raise too late and you can run short of runway. Plan the round around the milestone it funds.

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Save this for later

Share it with a founder working out when to start talking to investors.